BEGINNER TO IELTS ENGLISH WRITING MASTERY

TÀI LIỆU ĐỌC THÊM

GRAMMAR

Hướng dẫn ngữ pháp

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How to use this guide

This handbook is built in layers. Start with the foundation sections even if you already know some of the grammar. Most writing errors come from gaps in control, not gaps in memory. Move forward only when you can use the earlier sections in your own sentences.

Study rule	Read the rule, copy one model sentence, write three new sentences, then expand one of them into a short paragraph. Knowledge becomes writing only when you practise production.

Your roadmap

Stage 1 - Accuracy **Sections 1 to 7** Build sentence control, article use, tense choice, punctuation, and noun patterns.	**Stage 2 - Connection** **Sections 8 to 15** Connect ideas, explain causes and results, compare, contrast, and add formal variety carefully.
Stage 3 - Paragraphs **Section 16** Turn grammar into organised explanation and support.	**Stage 4 - IELTS tasks** **Sections 17 to 20** Learn the test formats, practise the right structure, and improve through editing.

What beginners should stop doing

- Do not memorise long fancy phrases that you cannot control.
- Do not force complex grammar into every sentence.
- Do not write essays without planning the main idea of each paragraph.
- Do not ignore repeated errors. Repeated small errors matter more than one rare mistake.

Mindset	Good IELTS writing is not about sounding intelligent all the time. It is about being relevant, organised, accurate, and clear.

Part 1

Build correct sentences

These foundation sections give you the grammar control that everything else depends on: sentence structure, word forms, tense choice, article use, and punctuation.

1. Sentence building and sentence types

Foundation - master this first

Before IELTS writing becomes an essay problem, it is a sentence problem. If your sentences are unclear, the reader cannot follow your ideas, even when your ideas are good. Beginners often try to sound advanced too early; the safer path is to build short, correct sentences first and then combine them.

Key idea	Accuracy comes before complexity. A short sentence with a clear meaning is always better than a long sentence full of grammar mistakes.

The five safe sentence patterns

Pattern	Formula	Example	Why it matters
1	Subject + verb	Prices rose.	Useful for short facts and direct statements.
2	Subject + verb + object	The policy reduced traffic.	This is the most common pattern in explanation writing.
3	Subject + verb + complement	Public transport is essential.	Good for definitions, opinions, and descriptions.
4	Subject + verb + indirect object + direct object	The scheme gave workers more support.	Useful when one thing is given, sent, or shown to another.
5	Subject + verb + object + complement	Many people consider English a global language.	Useful for opinion and evaluation.

Simple, compound, and complex sentences

- A simple sentence has one main clause: "Many students struggle with writing."
- A compound sentence joins two main clauses, often with and, but, so, or however: "Many students struggle with writing, so they need more guided practice."
- A complex sentence combines a main clause and a dependent clause: "Although many students know grammar rules, they still find it difficult to organise ideas."
- For beginners, a good paragraph usually mixes short simple sentences with a few controlled complex sentences. You do not need every sentence to be long.

Weak sentence	Better sentence	Why the upgrade works
People use the internet. It is useful.	People use the internet because it is useful for study, work, and communication.	The second sentence shows a clear reason and combines the two ideas naturally.

Weak sentence	Better sentence	Why the upgrade works
The city is crowded. There are many cars. It is bad.	The city is increasingly crowded because private car ownership has risen sharply, which creates heavy congestion.	This version removes repetition and adds a clearer cause-and-effect link.
Education is important. It helps people.	Education is important because it helps people develop skills, find better jobs, and make informed decisions.	The sentence becomes more specific and therefore more persuasive.

Common mistake	Do not create a run-on sentence by joining full sentences with only a comma. "The problem is serious, the government should act" is wrong. Use a full stop, a semicolon, or a conjunction: "The problem is serious, so the government should act."

Quick self-check

Ask three questions after each sentence: Who or what is this sentence about? What is the main verb? Can the reader understand the exact relationship between the ideas?

If you cannot answer those questions quickly, simplify the sentence before you try to improve it.

2. Parts of speech and word families

Foundation - learn how words change jobs

Strong writers do not only know vocabulary; they know what form of the word they need. A learner may know the word "improve" but still write "an improve" or "more improvement people". Word class control helps you build accurate sentences and paraphrase more naturally.

The main word classes you need every day

Word class	Job in the sentence	Examples	Typical beginner question
Noun	Names a person, thing, idea, or process	government, decision, pollution	What is the thing or idea?
Verb	Shows an action, process, or state	increase, reduce, seem	What happens?
Adjective	Describes a noun	effective, public, expensive	What kind of noun is it?
Adverb	Describes a verb, adjective, or sentence	carefully, extremely, generally	How, how much, or in what way?
Pronoun	Replaces a noun	it, they, this, these	What word can replace the noun?
Preposition	Shows relation	in, on, at, by, with, for	How are two things related?
Conjunction	Connects ideas	and, but, because, although	How do I join the ideas?

Use word families to paraphrase without changing meaning

Base idea	Verb	Noun	Adjective	Adverb
decide	decide	decision	decisive	decisively
improve	improve	improvement	improved / improving	significantly
economy	economise	economy / economics	economic / economical	economically
success	succeed	success	successful	successfully
analysis	analyse	analysis	analytical	analytically

- A noun is often needed after an article: a decision, an improvement, the economy.
- An adjective is often needed before a noun: economic growth, public health, environmental damage.
- An adverb often modifies a verb or an adjective: prices increased significantly; a highly effective system.

Weak sentence	Better sentence	Why the upgrade works
This policy has a good result.	This policy has a positive effect.	Effect is a more natural noun with policy, and positive is a clearer adjective than good.
The government made an improve.	The government made an improvement.	After an article such as an, you usually need a noun, not a verb.
This is a success program.	This is a successful programme.	Success is a noun; successful is the adjective needed before programme.

Writing tip	When you learn a new word, do not memorise one form only. Write the noun, verb, adjective, and one useful collocation. For example: invest - investment - invested - heavily invest in public transport.

3. Core tenses for writing

Foundation - choose time clearly

IELTS writing does not require every tense. In fact, most strong answers depend on a small number of core tense choices used correctly. Your goal is not to show every tense you know. Your goal is to match the tense to the meaning.

Safe rule	Present simple is the workhorse of IELTS writing. Use it for general truths, current situations, opinions, and most Task 2 arguments.

The tenses that matter most

Tense	Main use	Signal ideas	Model sentence
Present simple	facts, routines, general arguments	usually, often, in general	Public transport reduces congestion and improves access to work.
Past simple	finished past actions or old data	in 2010, last year, previously	The figure rose from 35 to 50 percent between 2010 and 2015.
Present perfect	change over time linked to now	since, over the last decade, recently	Online shopping has become more common in recent years.
Future forms	predictions, plans, likely results	in the future, if this continues	If this trend continues, energy demand will increase.
Passive voice	when the action matters more than the actor	is produced, was introduced	A new policy was introduced in 2022.

How tense choice changes meaning

- Use present simple when the statement is generally true: "Many parents worry about screen time."
- Use past simple for a completed time period: "Sales fell sharply in 2020."
- Use present perfect when the period reaches the present: "Sales have risen steadily since 2020."
- Use will, may, or might when you are predicting or discussing consequences: "This policy may reduce waste over time."

Weak sentence	Better sentence	Why the upgrade works
People are using bicycles more and more in many cities nowadays, so this is a good trend.	People have used bicycles more frequently in recent years, suggesting a positive shift towards cleaner transport.	The second version shows a clearer time reference and a more academic result clause.
Since 2018, unemployment fell.	Since 2018, unemployment has fallen.	Since usually connects past time to the present, so present perfect is often needed.
The chart shows people bought more cars in 2021 and 2022.	The chart shows that car purchases increased in 2021 and 2022.	The improved version chooses a more precise reporting verb and noun phrase.

Common mistake	Do not mix present and past without reason. "The chart shows that sales increased in 2019 and rise again in 2020" should be "rose again in 2020".

Tense shortcut for beginners

Task 2 essays: mostly present simple, with occasional modals and conditionals.

Task 1 Academic: usually past simple when the data are in the past, present simple when you introduce the chart, and present perfect only when the period continues to now.

4. Articles, nouns, and quantity

Foundation - one of the biggest score traps

Articles and noun control cause many repeated errors: a people, an advice, the pollution, many traffic. These mistakes may look small, but they appear again and again, so they reduce grammatical accuracy and clarity.

A, an, the, or no article?

Choice	Use it when...	Examples	Watch out
a / an	you mean one thing, not specific to the reader	a policy, an idea, a university	Do not use with plural nouns.
the	the reader knows which one, or it is specific	the government, the internet, the main reason	Use the only when the noun is clear and specific.
no article	plural or uncountable nouns used generally	students need feedback; pollution is harmful	Do not add the before a general plural noun.

Countable and uncountable nouns

Countable	Uncountable	Correct quantity words	Common error
student, job, problem	information, advice, furniture	many students; a few jobs; much information	an advice
car, house, device	traffic, research, equipment	fewer cars; less traffic; some research	many traffic
idea, solution, reason	pollution, knowledge, progress	several ideas; more knowledge; less pollution	a progress

- Use fewer with countable nouns: fewer cars, fewer mistakes.
- Use less with uncountable nouns: less traffic, less pollution.
- Some nouns are uncountable in English even if they are countable in other languages: advice, homework, luggage, evidence, news.

Weak sentence	Better sentence	Why the upgrade works
The government should give many advices.	The government should give a great deal of advice.	Advice is uncountable, so it does not normally take a plural form.
The pollution is a serious issue in many cities.	Pollution is a serious issue in many cities.	Here pollution is general, so no article is needed.
Less people use buses today.	Fewer people use buses today.	People is countable, so fewer is the correct choice.

IELTS use	Article errors are common, so they are not fatal by themselves. The bigger problem is repetition. Identify the nouns you often misuse and correct those patterns every week.

5. Pronouns, determiners, and agreement

Foundation - make reference clear

Good writing guides the reader smoothly from one sentence to the next. Pronouns and reference words such as it, they, this, and these help you do that, but only when the meaning is obvious. Unclear reference creates confusion quickly.

Agreement and clear reference

Area	Rule	Example	Why it matters
Subject-verb agreement	Singular subject takes singular verb	The number of users is rising.	The main verb must agree with the real subject.
Plural noun	Plural subject takes plural verb	Many students find writing difficult.	Very common accuracy point.
Pronoun reference	The pronoun must clearly match a noun	Public libraries help low-income families because they provide free access to books.	The reader must know who they refers to.
This / these	Use a noun after this / these when possible	This problem, these changes	This alone can be vague in formal writing.

- Write "This trend is worrying" rather than only "This is worrying" when the reference could be unclear.
- After a long sentence, do not use it or they unless the reader can identify the noun immediately.
- Words such as each, every, and everyone are usually singular: every student needs feedback; each child has different needs.

Weak sentence	Better sentence	Why the upgrade works
When people move to cities, it creates pressure on housing.	When people move to cities, this migration creates pressure on housing.	It is unclear in the weak version. The improved version names the process directly.
The number of cars are increasing.	The number of cars is increasing.	The subject is number, not cars.
Every students need support.	Every student needs support.	Every is singular, so the noun and verb should also be singular.

Common mistake	Do not overuse this, these, and it at the start of every sentence. Repeating vague pronouns can make a paragraph sound empty. Name the real noun whenever the meaning may not be obvious.

Determiners worth memorising

some, many, much, several, each, every, either, neither, both, another, other, the other

These small words control quantity and reference, so they matter more than many learners expect.

6. Adjectives, adverbs, and basic comparison

Foundation - describe ideas with control

Adjectives and adverbs let you describe quality, degree, and change. They are simple tools, but they become powerful when you use them precisely. A beginner does not need dramatic vocabulary; a careful choice such as significant, gradual, or equally can already improve the quality of writing.

Adjective or adverb?

Need	Use	Examples	Common mistake
Describe a noun	adjective	a significant rise; public transport; effective policy	He gave a carefully answer.
Describe a verb	adverb	prices rose sharply; people responded positively	The figure increased rapid.
Describe another adjective	adverb	highly effective; extremely expensive	very benefit

The comparison structures you need first

Structure	Use	Example	Beginner warning
comparative + than	compare two things	Public transport is cheaper than private car use.	Do not write more cheaper.
the + superlative	show the highest or lowest point	This was the most noticeable change.	Remember the with superlatives.
as + adjective + as	show equal comparison	Rural access is not as high as urban access.	Good for balanced comparison.
less / least	show lower degree	This option is less practical for small towns.	Use less for comparison, not lesser here.

- Use a stronger adjective before you use an extreme one. significant is usually safer than amazing in academic writing.
- Adverbs such as gradually, steadily, sharply, and slightly are especially useful in Task 1 Academic.
- Words like beneficial, harmful, effective, and sustainable are high-value adjectives for Task 2.

Weak sentence	Better sentence	Why the upgrade works
This change is very big.	This change is significant.	Significant is more precise and more academic than very big.
The number increased rapid.	The number increased rapidly.	A verb normally needs an adverb, not an adjective.
This option is more easier for students.	This option is easier for students.	Do not use double comparison.

Writing tip	When you learn a new adjective, also learn a noun it often goes with: significant increase, heavy traffic, limited access, strong evidence, practical solution.

7. Punctuation, prepositions, and common sentence problems

Foundation - small forms, big consequences

Many writing errors do not come from big grammar rules. They come from small control problems: missing commas, wrong prepositions, sentence fragments, and comma splices. These errors make a script look less controlled even when the ideas are acceptable.

Punctuation that beginners should control

Mark	Main beginner use	Example	Do not do this
Full stop	end one complete idea	Governments should invest more in rail systems.	Do not join two full sentences without a proper connector.
Comma	separate extra information or introductory words	However, this solution is expensive.	Do not use a comma alone to join two full sentences.
Colon	introduce a list or explanation after a complete clause	There are three main causes: cost, distance, and time.	Do not use a colon after a verb that already introduces the list.
Semicolon	link two closely related full clauses	The plan is costly; however, it may be effective.	Use it only when both sides are full clauses.

Prepositions that appear often in academic writing

Pattern	Natural example	Meaning
increase in	an increase in demand	change within something
increase by	sales increased by 15 percent	size of the change
increase to	sales increased to 70 percent	new final level
reason for	the reason for the decline	cause or explanation
impact on	the policy had an impact on workers	effect on someone or something
solution to	a solution to traffic congestion	answer to a problem

Weak sentence	Better sentence	Why the upgrade works
There are many reasons of this problem.	There are many reasons for this problem.	Reason normally takes for, not of, in this pattern.
The issue is serious, the city should act.	The issue is serious, so the city should act.	The weak version is a comma splice; the improved version uses a conjunction.

Common mistake	A fragment is not a full sentence. "Because it is expensive." is only a dependent clause. Add the main clause: "Because it is expensive, many families cannot afford it."

Minimal punctuation goal

For IELTS, you do not need stylish punctuation. You need reliable punctuation. Full stops, commas, and the occasional colon or semicolon are enough if you use them correctly.

Part 2

Connect, compare, and sound more formal

This part covers the grammar and linking tools that make writing more flexible: conjunctions, explanation patterns, conditionals, concession, comparison, and careful academic style.

8. Conjunctions and cohesive devices

Core - essential for clear IELTS writing

Cohesion is the visible glue of writing. It tells the reader how one idea connects to the next: addition, contrast, reason, result, example, or conclusion. Many learners know a lot of linking words, but they use them too often or in the wrong place. The goal is natural connection, not decoration.

Safe rule	Use a small set of connectors very well before you try to use many different ones. Overused linkers can make writing sound mechanical.

Three groups to remember

Group	Main job	Examples	Best use
Coordinating conjunctions	join equal ideas	and, but, or, so, yet	inside a sentence
Subordinating conjunctions	show reason, time, condition, contrast	because, although, if, when, while, unless	build complex sentences
Linking adverbs / transition signals	connect one sentence to another	however, therefore, moreover, for example, in conclusion	guide paragraph flow

Useful linkers by function

Function	Reliable options	One model sentence
Addition	furthermore, in addition, also	In addition, better public transport can reduce household costs.
Contrast	however, in contrast, on the other hand	However, this approach may not work in rural areas.
Reason	because, since, as	Many people prefer online learning because it is flexible.
Result	therefore, as a result, consequently	As a result, small businesses may lose customers.
Example	for example, for instance	For example, students in remote areas may rely on online classes.
Conclusion	overall, in conclusion	Overall, the long-term benefits appear greater than the short-term costs.

- Use however, therefore, and moreover mostly between sentences, not repeatedly inside every sentence.
- Because and although are strong beginner tools because they let you build explanation and contrast directly.

- One paragraph does not need five different linkers. Sometimes the relationship is already clear from the sentence order.

Weak sentence	Better sentence	Why the upgrade works
People need public transport. It is cheaper. It is cleaner.	People need public transport because it is both cheaper and cleaner than private car use.	The improved sentence combines the ideas and shows the reason directly.
However many people use cars because they are convenient.	However, many people still use cars because they are convenient.	A linking adverb at the start of a sentence usually needs a comma after it.
On the other hand, public transport is cheap. On the other hand, it is not always reliable.	Public transport is cheap; however, it is not always reliable.	Repeating the same connector sounds unnatural. Use variation and punctuation better.

Common mistake	Do not write although ... but in the same clause. Use one or the other: "Although it is expensive, it is effective" or "It is expensive, but it is effective."

9. Expressing opinions, reasons, and explanations

Core - this is where writing starts to sound intelligent

A strong writer does more than state an opinion. A strong writer explains it. In IELTS Task 2, it is not enough to write "I agree" or "This is good". You need a clear position, a reason, and support. Beginners often improve quickly when they learn explanation frames rather than memorised essay templates.

Safe opinion language

Purpose	Reliable phrase	Model sentence
Give your view	In my view, ...	In my view, governments should prioritise preventive healthcare.
Show moderate certainty	It seems that ...	It seems that remote work will remain common in many industries.
Present a balanced claim	While this view has some merit, ...	While this view has some merit, it ignores the needs of rural communities.
State a reason	One reason is that ...	One reason is that reliable transport improves access to employment.
State a result	This can lead to ...	This can lead to lower stress levels and better time management.

Explanation frames that beginners should practise

Frame	Formula	Example
Cause and effect	X happens because Y; therefore Z happens	Many adults choose online courses because they need flexible schedules; therefore, demand for digital learning has grown.
Claim and example	Claim + explanation + for example	Public parks improve urban life because they give residents free space for exercise. For example, families can use them daily without paying fees.
Problem and solution	The problem is X; a practical solution is Y	The main problem is overcrowding; a practical solution is to expand bus and rail systems.
Concession	Although X, Y remains true	Although private cars are convenient, they still create serious congestion.

Weak sentence	Better sentence	Why the upgrade works
I think online learning is good.	In my view, online learning is valuable because it gives learners greater flexibility and wider access to courses.	The improved version adds both a position and a reason.
This is bad for society.	This can be harmful for society because it weakens face-to-face interaction and may increase isolation.	The stronger sentence explains the nature of the harm.
People should use public transport. It helps traffic.	People should use public transport because higher usage can reduce the number of	The improved sentence is more specific and more persuasive.

Weak sentence	Better sentence	Why the upgrade works
	private vehicles on the road and ease traffic congestion.	

Writing tip	When you finish a sentence that gives your opinion, ask: Why? How? Example? If you cannot answer at least one of those questions, the idea is still underdeveloped.

A fast paragraph formula

Point: state one clear idea.

Explain: show why it is true.

Example: give real, general, or hypothetical support.

Link: connect the idea back to the question.

10. Conditional sentences

Core - excellent for discussing consequences and solutions

Conditionals let you talk about facts, likely future results, hypothetical situations, and regrets about the past. They are especially useful in IELTS when you discuss policy, advice, predictions, or the possible results of an action.

The five practical conditional patterns

Type	Form	Main meaning	Model sentence
Zero	if + present, present	general truth	If people exercise regularly, they usually feel healthier.
First	if + present, will / can / may + base	real future possibility	If cities improve bus services, more commuters will leave their cars at home.
Second	if + past, would / could / might + base	unreal or unlikely present / future	If I were a policymaker, I would invest more in affordable housing.
Third	if + past perfect, would have + past participle	imagined past result	If the government had acted earlier, the crisis might have been less severe.
Mixed	past condition + present result	past cause with present effect	If more attention had been given to education, the workforce would be stronger today.

- Use the first conditional when you recommend an action and describe a likely result.
- Use the second conditional to discuss hypothetical policy or personal choice.
- Use the third conditional when you evaluate missed opportunities in the past.
- For formal writing, were is safer than was in second conditional patterns: If I were, if the government were.

Weak sentence	Better sentence	Why the upgrade works
If the government will invest more, transport improves.	If the government invests more, transport will improve.	In normal first conditionals, the if-clause does not take will.
If I was the mayor, I will build more housing.	If I were the mayor, I would build more housing.	The improved version uses a correct second conditional form.
If they acted earlier, the problem would have been solved.	If they had acted earlier, the problem would have been solved.	A past unreal condition needs past perfect in the if-clause.

IELTS use	Conditionals are helpful, but they are not required in every paragraph. Use them when they add real meaning, not simply to show off grammar.

11. Inversion and emphasis

Upgrade - useful, but only after your basics are stable

Inversion is an advanced feature. It can make writing sound formal and varied, but it is optional. If you are still making frequent basic errors, do not force inversion into your essay. Clear grammar is far more important than rare grammar.

Use sparingly	One well-controlled advanced sentence is enough. Too much inversion sounds unnatural and increases the risk of serious mistakes.

Common inversion patterns

Pattern	Formula	Example	Best use
Negative adverb	Never / rarely / seldom + auxiliary + subject + verb	Rarely do policymakers consider the long-term social cost.	formal emphasis
Not only ... but also	Not only + auxiliary + subject + verb, but ...	Not only does this policy save money, but it also improves public health.	double emphasis
Conditional inversion 1	Should + subject + base verb	Should further support be required, schools can request extra funding.	formal first conditional
Conditional inversion 2	Were + subject + to + base verb	Were the city to expand cycle lanes, commuting patterns could change.	formal second conditional
Conditional inversion 3	Had + subject + past participle	Had the project started earlier, the result would have been better.	formal third conditional

- Inversion is more natural in formal letters and high-level essays than in simple beginner paragraphs.
- Do not use inversion only because it sounds impressive. Use it when you want to add emphasis or variety in a controlled way.

Weak sentence	Better sentence	Why the upgrade works
The policy was not only expensive, but it also failed.	Not only was the policy expensive, but it also failed.	The second version adds emphasis through inversion.
If more support were provided, the system could improve.	Were more support to be provided, the system could improve.	This is a formal inversion of the second conditional.
Never I have seen such a rapid change.	Never have I seen such a rapid change.	The auxiliary moves before the subject in this structure.

12. Concession and contrast

Core - necessary for balanced arguments

Balanced writing often needs contrast. You may agree partly, recognise a weakness, or compare two viewpoints. Concession language helps you do this. It is also a powerful way to avoid one-sided essays.

Structures for contrast and concession

Structure	Form	Example	Watch out
although / even though / though	followed by subject + verb	Although public transport is cheaper, many commuters still prefer cars.	Do not add but after although.
despite / in spite of	followed by noun phrase or -ing	Despite the high cost, many families still buy private cars.	Do not use a full clause directly after despite.
while / whereas	compare two contrasting facts	Urban areas improved rapidly, whereas rural areas changed more slowly.	Very useful in Task 1 comparison.
however	sentence connector	However, this solution may be difficult to fund.	Usually needs punctuation.

- A concession sentence often improves maturity because it shows that you recognise a limitation before you defend your main point.
- You do not need to agree with both sides equally. You only need to show that you understand the contrast and organise it clearly.

Weak sentence	Better sentence	Why the upgrade works
Although the plan is expensive but it is useful.	Although the plan is expensive, it is useful.	Do not use although and but together in the same clause.
Despite the government invests more, the problem continues.	Despite increased government spending, the problem continues.	After despite, use a noun phrase or -ing form, not a full clause.
Many students work hard. However they still feel stressed.	Many students work hard. However, they still feel stressed.	A sentence connector at the start usually needs a comma.

Writing tip	A good balanced paragraph can follow this pattern: acknowledge the other side, explain its limit, then restate your stronger view.

13. Subjunctive and recommendation patterns

Upgrade - very useful for formal suggestions

This structure appears in formal English when people suggest, recommend, insist, request, or describe what is necessary or essential. It is highly useful in policy essays because it sounds precise and formal.

The core pattern

Trigger	Pattern	Example
suggest / recommend / propose	verb + that + subject + base verb	Experts recommend that schools provide more digital training.
insist / demand / request / require	verb + that + subject + base verb	Residents demanded that the council improve local bus services.
essential / important / necessary / vital	it + be + adjective + that + subject + base verb	It is essential that every child receive equal access to education.
Alternative form	subject + should + base verb	Experts recommend that schools should provide more digital training.

- After that, use the base form: suggest that he go; insist that the policy be revised; require that students attend.
- In modern English, the should version is also widely accepted and may feel easier for beginners: It is important that governments should act quickly. However, the base form is shorter and more formal.

Weak sentence	Better sentence	Why the upgrade works
They suggested that he takes a break.	They suggested that he take a break.	After suggest that, the verb stays in the base form.
It is essential that every applicant is present.	It is essential that every applicant be present.	Be is the formal subjunctive form here.
The report recommended to improve public transport.	The report recommended that the city improve public transport.	Recommend is often followed by that-clause in formal advice.

IELTS use	This structure is especially useful in Task 2 topics about education, health, transport, law, and environmental policy.

14. Comparison structures

Core - crucial for Task 1 and useful for Task 2

Comparison is a central writing skill. In Task 1 Academic, you often compare categories, groups, years, or trends. In Task 2, you compare options, advantages, disadvantages, and viewpoints. Good comparison language helps you avoid repetitive sentences.

Comparison tools worth mastering

Structure	Main use	Example	Note
more / less + adjective	compare degree	Online learning is more flexible than traditional classroom study.	Use with many long adjectives.
the most / the least	superlative comparison	This was the least popular option.	Useful in Task 1 descriptions.
as ... as / not as ... as	equal or lower comparison	Bus travel is not as convenient as car use for some commuters.	Simple but powerful.
the more ..., the more ...	show linked change	The more people drive, the more congestion cities face.	Very useful for explanation.
by far the most / least	strong superlative emphasis	This was by far the most significant rise in the chart.	Use sparingly.

- In Task 1, comparison is usually more important than detail listing. Group similar data and show the biggest differences.
- Useful verbs for comparison include exceed, remain below, overtake, match, and lag behind.
- Useful nouns for comparison include gap, contrast, difference, similarity, peak, and proportion.

Weak sentence	Better sentence	Why the upgrade works
The blue line is bigger than the red line.	The blue line remains above the red line throughout the period.	Task 1 usually needs precise comparison language, not everyday adjectives like bigger.
People in cities use the internet more than villages.	Internet use is considerably higher in urban areas than in rural areas.	The improved version uses a more natural comparison frame.
The more cars increase, the traffic becomes worse.	The more car ownership increases, the worse traffic becomes.	Both halves of the double comparative need parallel structure.

Writing tip	When describing data, compare what matters most: highest and lowest values, major changes, categories that move together, and the size of the gap between groups.

15. Nominalisation and academic style

Upgrade - helps writing sound more formal when used carefully

Nominalisation means turning actions or qualities into nouns: decide becomes decision, improve becomes improvement, fail becomes failure. This can make writing sound more academic because it focuses on ideas, processes, and results. However, too much nominalisation can make writing heavy and unclear.

Do not overdo it	A clear verb is often stronger than a heavy noun phrase. Use nominalisation to improve style, not to hide simple meaning.

From verb or adjective to noun

Everyday version	Nominalised version	When the noun version helps
The government failed to act.	The government's failure to act...	when the failure itself is the topic
The city expanded the metro system.	The expansion of the metro system...	when you want to focus on the process or policy
This policy is effective.	The effectiveness of this policy...	when you want to discuss evaluation as an idea
People opposed the law.	Public opposition to the law...	when the reaction is the main topic

Academic style upgrades that are safe for beginners

Informal or weak	Safer academic choice	Comment
a lot of	many / much / a great deal of / a significant amount of	choose by noun type
kids	children	more formal and more accurate
good / bad	beneficial / harmful / effective / problematic	be more precise
shows	indicates / demonstrates / suggests	better for analysis
I think	In my view / I believe / It seems that	use sparingly and clearly

- Formal style does not mean using difficult words everywhere. It means avoiding slang, contractions, and vague emotional language.
- Hedging is useful when the claim should sound measured: may, might, can, tends to, appears to, is likely to.
- Precise verbs often improve style more than long nouns do: reduce, encourage, discourage, enable, restrict, outweigh, highlight.

Weak sentence	Better sentence	Why the upgrade works
People moved to cities quickly.	Rapid urban migration occurred.	The noun phrase sounds more academic, but only use it when it still feels clear.
This is good for the economy.	This can be beneficial for economic growth.	The improved version is more precise and more formal.

Weak sentence	Better sentence	Why the upgrade works
The government should not just do something fast.	The government should implement timely measures.	Implement and measures are formal but still transparent.

High-value academic verbs

increase, decrease, improve, reduce, contribute to, result in, lead to, encourage, discourage, enable, prevent, address, highlight, indicate, demonstrate, outweigh

These verbs are more useful than memorising many rare adjectives.

Part 3

Turn grammar into IELTS writing

Now you move from sentence-level control to paragraphs, essays, reports, letters, and disciplined editing.

IELTS writing at a glance

Before you practise individual tasks, make sure you understand the overall structure of the Writing section and the four areas examiners score.

Module / task	What you do	Minimum	Suggested time
Academic Task 1	describe visual information such as a graph, chart, table, map, or process	150 words	20 minutes
General Task 1	write a letter in a personal, semi-formal, or formal style	150 words	20 minutes
Task 2	write an essay responding to a point of view, argument, or problem	250 words	40 minutes

Scoring area	Simple meaning	What strong beginners do
Task achievement / response	answer the task fully and directly	cover every part of the question and keep a clear position
Coherence and cohesion	organise ideas and connect them clearly	use logical paragraphs and controlled linkers
Lexical resource	choose words accurately and appropriately	use precise everyday academic words rather than memorised rare words
Grammatical range and accuracy	show sentence variety with control	mix clear simple sentences with some correct complex ones

Important	Task 2 carries more weight than Task 1, so if your practice time is limited, spend the larger share on essay skills.

16. Paragraph mastery and explanation patterns

Writing skill - turn grammar into real paragraphs

Most IELTS writing problems are not caused by a lack of ideas. They are caused by weak paragraph control. A good paragraph has one clear purpose. It does not jump in five directions. It leads the reader from claim to explanation to support.

One paragraph, one job	When a paragraph tries to discuss too many different ideas, development becomes thin. Give each paragraph one main point and develop it well.

A simple paragraph blueprint

Part	What it does	Useful question	Mini model
Point	states the main idea	What is my one clear claim?	Public transport deserves more investment than road expansion.
Explain	shows why the claim is true	Why is this point valid?	It moves large numbers of people more efficiently and with less pollution.
Example	adds support or illustration	Can I make this idea more concrete?	For example, frequent rail systems can reduce commuter dependence on private cars.
Link	ties the paragraph back to the question	How does this support my overall answer?	For this reason, transport budgets should not focus only on roads.

The sentence expansion ladder

Stage	Sentence	What improved
1	Public transport is important.	basic claim only
2	Public transport is important because it gives many people affordable mobility.	added reason
3	Public transport is important because it gives many people affordable mobility, especially in large cities where travel costs can be high.	added specificity
4	Public transport is important because it gives many people affordable mobility, especially in large cities where travel costs can be high; as a result, it can improve access to work and education.	added result and stronger explanation

Explanation patterns that work across many topics

Pattern	Useful frame	Example topic
Cause and effect	X happens because Y, which leads to Z	traffic, pollution, stress
Problem and solution	The main problem is X; a realistic solution is Y	housing, waste, congestion
Opinion and reason	I agree that X because Y and Z	education, technology, law

Pattern	Useful frame	Example topic
Compare and contrast	Although X has advantages, Y is more effective because ...	public vs private services
Advantage and disadvantage	The main benefit is X; however, the main drawback is Y	online learning, tourism, remote work

Model body paragraph

Governments should spend more on public transport because it benefits a wider group of people than road expansion alone. Buses and rail systems can carry large numbers of passengers efficiently, which helps reduce congestion and lowers travel costs for commuters. For example, when cities improve the frequency and coverage of trains, workers can reach jobs more easily without depending on private cars. As a result, investment in public transport often creates economic, social, and environmental benefits at the same time.

Practice habit	Take one weak sentence from your notebook every day and expand it in three stages: add a reason, add an example, then add a result.

17. IELTS Writing Task 2

Exam skill - the higher-value writing task

Task 2 is the essay task in both IELTS Academic and General Training. It carries more weight than Task 1, so for most learners it deserves the largest share of practice time. The best beginners do not start with complex essay tricks. They start with a clear position, logical paragraphs, and controlled grammar.

Task 2 at a glance

What you must know	Official test reality	What this means for you
Length	minimum 250 words	Write enough to develop your ideas, but do not chase unnecessary length.
Time	about 40 minutes	Plan quickly, write clearly, and leave 3 to 5 minutes to check.
Scoring areas	Task response, coherence and cohesion, lexical resource, grammatical range and accuracy	A good essay needs both ideas and language control.
Weight	Task 2 counts more than Task 1	Improve Task 2 first if your writing time is limited.

Avoid this	Do not write your answer in bullet points, and do not rely on memorised blocks of language that do not fit the question. Essays need full connected text and relevant development.

Common essay types

Question type	What you must do	Simple structure
Agree / disagree	state your position and support it clearly	introduction - body 1 - body 2 - conclusion
Discuss both views	explain both sides and give your own opinion	introduction - view A - view B + opinion - conclusion
Advantages / disadvantages	present both sides and judge their importance	introduction - advantages - disadvantages - conclusion
Problem / solution	describe the issue and propose solutions	introduction - problems - solutions - conclusion
Two-part question	answer both questions fully	introduction - answer 1 - answer 2 - conclusion

A beginner-friendly 40-minute plan

1. 2 to 4 minutes: read the question, identify the topic, task, and key words.
2. 4 to 6 minutes: decide your position and brainstorm one main idea for each body paragraph.
3. 25 to 28 minutes: write the essay in full paragraphs.
4. 3 to 5 minutes: check task coverage, paragraph unity, articles, agreement, and spelling.

What band 6 and band 7 writing generally feel like

Area	Band 6 tendency	Band 7 tendency
Task response	answers the main parts but development may be uneven	addresses the main parts clearly and develops ideas with better focus
Organisation	generally clear, but linking can be mechanical	logical progression with more natural paragraphing and linking
Vocabulary	adequate but sometimes repetitive or imprecise	more flexible and more precise, with fewer noticeable errors
Grammar	mix of simple and complex forms, but complex control is limited	greater variety with generally good control and errors that do not block meaning

A safe introduction template

Paraphrase the topic in one sentence.

Answer the question directly in one sentence.

Example: Governments spend large amounts of money on both road infrastructure and public transport systems. In my view, greater investment should be directed towards public transport because it serves more people efficiently and can reduce congestion in the long term.

Model plan for one prompt

Prompt: Some people think governments should spend more money on public transport than on roads. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

Position: Mostly agree.

Body paragraph 1: public transport serves more people and reduces congestion.

Body paragraph 2: roads are still necessary, but expanding them alone often encourages more car use.

Conclusion: public transport should receive greater priority while roads are maintained where necessary.

Model Task 2 answer

Governments often face difficult decisions about transport funding, especially when they must choose between expanding road networks and improving public transport. In my view, a larger share of public money should be spent on buses, trains, and metro systems because these options benefit more people and create fewer long-term problems than road building alone.

The strongest argument for prioritising public transport is efficiency. A well-designed rail or bus system can move thousands of passengers every day, whereas road expansion mainly makes private car use easier. When more people depend on cars, congestion usually returns quickly, and cities must then deal with noise, pollution, and wasted travel time. By contrast, reliable public transport can reduce the number of vehicles on the road while also making travel cheaper for workers and students.

Admittedly, roads still require investment. Rural areas, emergency services, and goods transport all depend on road infrastructure, so it would be unrealistic to ignore this need completely. However, giving roads the largest share of funding is rarely the best long-term strategy, particularly in crowded urban areas. In many cases, improving bus frequency or rail coverage offers a wider public benefit than building additional lanes.

Overall, although road maintenance remains important, governments should give greater priority to public transport because it supports economic access, reduces congestion, and is usually more sustainable.

18. IELTS Writing Task 1 Academic

Exam skill - report visual information accurately

Academic Task 1 asks you to describe visual information such as a graph, table, chart, map, or process. This task is not about giving personal opinions. It is mainly an information-transfer task: select the key features, organise them clearly, and support them with accurate data.

Task 1 Academic at a glance

What you must know	Official test reality	What this means for you
Length	minimum 150 words	Write enough for an overview and key comparisons.
Time	about 20 minutes	Do not spend too long on detail; Task 2 carries more weight.
Main scoring focus	Task achievement, coherence and cohesion, lexical resource, grammatical range and accuracy	Select key features and make comparisons, not a list of every number.
Core mindset	describe what the data show	Do not explain causes unless the visual itself gives them.

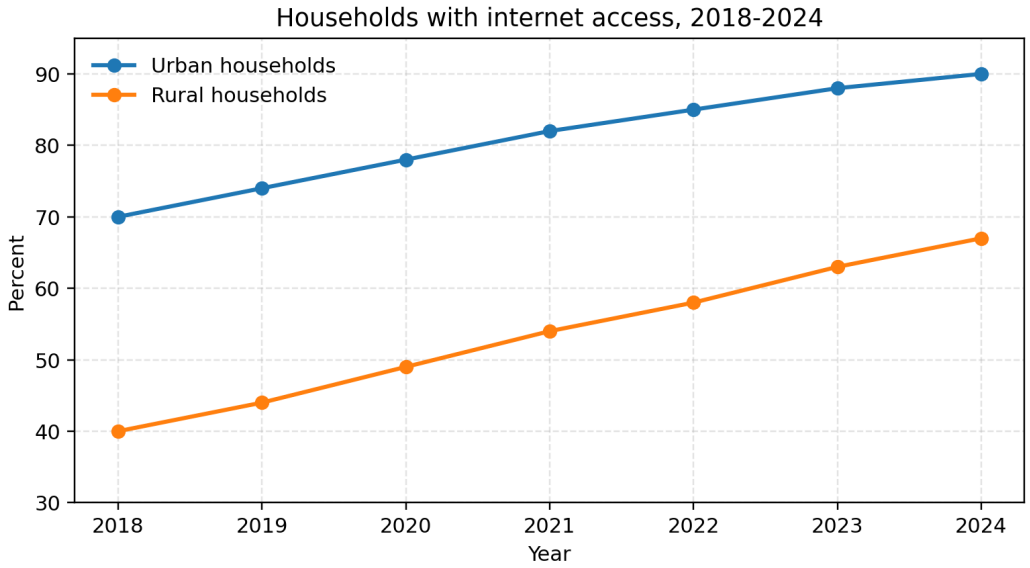
Golden rule	Your overview matters. The examiner wants to see that you can identify the main trends, differences, or stages, not just copy numbers.

A simple process for reports

5. Read the title, units, and time period carefully.
6. Identify the biggest features: highest, lowest, fastest change, and clear contrasts.
7. Group related data rather than describing each number separately.
8. Write an introduction, an overview, and then one or two detail paragraphs.
9. Use figures selectively to support the main trends you mention.

Useful language for trends and comparisons

Purpose	Useful language	Model sentence
rise	increase, grow, climb, rise	The proportion rose steadily over the period.
fall	decrease, decline, drop, fall	The figure fell slightly after 2021.
stability	remain stable, stay constant	The rural figure remained relatively stable for two years.
comparison	higher than, lower than, exceed, remain below	Urban access remained higher than rural access throughout.
degree	slightly, gradually, steadily, sharply, significantly	The percentage increased significantly between 2021 and 2024.



Sample line graph for Task 1 Academic practice

Model overview

Overall, internet access increased steadily in both urban and rural households over the period. Urban households consistently recorded higher levels of access, although the gap between the two groups narrowed slightly by the end of the period.

Model Task 1 response

The line graph compares the percentage of urban and rural households that had internet access between 2018 and 2024.

Overall, the proportion rose steadily in both groups. Urban homes consistently had higher internet access than rural homes, although the difference became smaller towards the end of the period.

In urban areas, the figure stood at 70 percent in 2018 and then increased each year, reaching 82 percent in 2021. Growth continued after that point, although at a slower pace, and the proportion eventually peaked at 90 percent in 2024.

Rural households started at a much lower level, at 40 percent in 2018. However, access also rose continuously, climbing to 54 percent by 2021 and then to 67 percent in the final year. While the gap between the two categories remained substantial throughout, it fell from 30 percentage points at the start to 23 points in 2024.

Weak sentence	Better sentence	Why the upgrade works
The graph shows two lines about internet.	The line graph compares the percentage of urban and rural households with internet access from 2018 to 2024.	The improved sentence identifies chart type, groups, measure, and time period.
I think the reason is technology became cheaper.	Do not add reasons unless the chart shows them.	Task 1 reports data; it does not usually ask for explanation beyond the data itself.

19. IELTS Writing Task 1 General Training

Exam skill - write a clear and appropriate letter

General Training Task 1 asks you to write a letter of at least 150 words. The letter may be personal, semi-formal, or formal, depending on who you are writing to and why. The task gives you three bullet points, and a strong answer covers all three naturally in full sentences.

Task 1 General Training at a glance

What you must know	Official test reality	What this means for you
Length	minimum 150 words	Write enough to cover all bullet points clearly.
Time	about 20 minutes	Plan the purpose and tone quickly before writing.
Tone	personal, semi-formal, or formal	Choose greeting, style, and closing that match the reader.
Main goal	communicate purpose and cover the task requirements	A clear purpose and complete bullet-point coverage matter a lot.

Choose the right style

Reader / situation	Style	Useful opening	Useful closing
friend or close contact	personal	Hi Sam, / Dear Anna,	Best wishes, / See you soon,
teacher, colleague, landlord	semi-formal	Dear Mr Khan,	Kind regards, / Best regards,
manager, company, local authority	formal	Dear Sir or Madam, / Dear Ms Brown,	Yours faithfully, / Yours sincerely,

- State your purpose early: I am writing to complain about..., I am writing to request..., I am writing to explain...
- Use one paragraph for each bullet point when possible.
- Do not copy the bullet points word for word; turn them into natural sentences.

Model prompt

You recently moved into a rented apartment, but you are having problems with the heating system. Write a letter to the rental agency.

In your letter: describe the problem; explain how it affects you; say what you would like the agency to do.

Model General Training letter

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am writing to report a problem with the heating system in the apartment I rented through your agency last month.

For the past week, the heating has worked only intermittently, and several rooms remain very cold even when the system is switched on. This appears to be more than a minor fault, as the temperature drops quickly each evening.

The problem has become increasingly inconvenient because I work from home and spend long hours in the apartment during the day. In addition, an elderly family member is currently staying with me, so a reliable heating system is particularly important.

I would be grateful if you could arrange for a technician to inspect the system as soon as possible. If repairs cannot be completed immediately, I would appreciate a temporary solution, such as portable heaters, until the issue is resolved.

Yours faithfully,

Amina Rahman

Common mistake	Many learners forget tone. A formal letter should not sound like a text message. Avoid contractions, slang, and overly casual phrases when writing to an agency or manager.

20. Final editing checklist and 30-day study plan

Writing habit - improvement comes from repetition and correction

Good writing improves through revision. Most learners write a paragraph once, look at it for ten seconds, and move on. That is too little. A stronger habit is to check the same small set of error patterns every day until they become automatic.

Check	What to look for	Fast action
[ ]	Did I answer every part of the question?	Underline task words and compare them with each paragraph.
[ ]	Is my position clear from the introduction to the conclusion?	Rewrite one sentence if the viewpoint feels vague.
[ ]	Does each paragraph have one main idea?	Cut or move sentences that introduce a new idea.
[ ]	Did I explain my main points, not just state them?	Add a reason, example, or result.
[ ]	Are my linkers natural and not repetitive?	Replace repeated however / moreover with better sentence order when possible.
[ ]	Did I check articles, plural nouns, and agreement?	Review nouns and verbs one sentence at a time.
[ ]	Are there any sentence fragments or comma splices?	Split or reconnect the sentence correctly.
[ ]	Is my vocabulary precise enough?	Replace weak words like good, bad, big with clearer choices.
[ ]	Did I leave time to correct spelling and punctuation?	Read the final lines slowly.

Best beginner habit	Rewrite one paragraph daily, not one full essay once a week. Frequent small correction is usually more effective than occasional long practice.

A practical 30-day plan

Week	Main focus	Daily work	Output goal
Week 1	sentence accuracy	review Sections 1 to 7; write and correct 8 to 10 model sentences each day	one clean paragraph by the end of the week
Week 2	connection and explanation	review Sections 8 to 16; turn short ideas into full explanations	three strong body paragraphs
Week 3	Task 2 essay control	plan and write short Task 2 answers; focus on structure and checking	two complete essays
Week 4	Task 1 practice and revision	alternate Academic or General Task 1 with editing drills	two Task 1 answers plus one revised Task 2 essay

Daily 20-minute writing loop

5 minutes: review one rule and copy one model sentence.

5 minutes: write three new sentences using that rule.

5 minutes: expand one of those sentences into a short paragraph.

5 minutes: edit for articles, agreement, linking, and punctuation.

Official IELTS references to check before your test

IELTS Academic format: Writing

IELTS General Training format: Writing

IELTS Writing key assessment criteria

IELTS Writing band descriptors and key assessment criteria

Because official test information can change, it is wise to check the IELTS website again before booking or taking the test.

Final message: You do not need perfect English to make strong progress. You need clear grammar, clear explanation, and consistent correction. Build one reliable sentence, then one reliable paragraph, then one reliable essay.